

Field 42 Mix

Four stereo pairs into one stereo master, with Field 42 preamps, M/S decoding, limiters, VU and iron output.



Overview

Field 42 Mix is the Field 42 channel as a four-pair location mixer: four stereo inputs summed to one stereo master. Each pair has the Field 42 front end (sweep HPF, transformer preamp, safety limiter), M/S decoding, pan, fader, mute and solo. The master has its own fader, the output limiter, the output transformer and a line-up tone. The VU reads the mix before the master fader; the LEDs read the master output.

Routing: the inputs arrive on the track's channels 1/2, 3/4, 5/6 and 7/8 and the master leaves on 1/2. Set the track to 8 channels (or more) in REAPER's routing window, then send each source to its pair - for example, a send to channels 3/4 for the second pair.

Reach for it for

- A submix of up to four stereo sources with location-mixer character
- Mid / side mic pairs, decoded with adjustable width

- Drum, band or field-recording submixes with a safety limiter on the master

Controls

Each pair (1 - 2, 3 - 4, 5 - 6, 7 - 8)

Lights	Red: the preamp's output above -1 dBFS. Amber: the input limiter working.
HPF	80 to 240 Hz, 12 dB per octave, before the preamp; fully left is OFF.
TRIM	Gain into the preamp, -20 to +40 dB.
LIM	The input safety limiter (-2 dBFS, 20:1). On by default.
Ø	Polarity reverse. With M/S on it flips the side signal, swapping left and right.
M/S	Treats the pair as a mid / side mic: left = mid, right = side. PAN becomes WIDTH (0 - 200%, 100% by default).
PAN / WIDTH	Constant-loudness pan, +3 dB at the sides (a balance on stereo pairs), or the M/S width.
FADER	Unity at 0 dB; -40 dB (OFF) to +10 dB.
MUTE / SOLO	Mute the pair, or solo it (any solo mutes the pairs that aren't soloed).

MASTER

VU meter	The mix before the master fader, VU ballistics, 0 VU = -20 dBFS.
OFF / ON / LINK	The output limiter: off, each side on its own, or stereo-linked (the default). The light shows it working.
LIMIT	Its threshold, +4 to +20 dBu (-16 to 0 dBFS), 20:1.

IRON	The output transformer.
DRIFT	See Drift below.
MASTER	The master fader.
TONE	A line-up oscillator that replaces the mix: 1 kHz, 400 Hz or 100 Hz, -20 to +8 dBu.
OUT meters	The master output, left and right.

Presets and size

PRESETS	Opens the list of factory presets (or click the preset display).
◀ / ▶	Step through the presets.
Preset display	Shows the preset number and name. Click it for the list.
S / M / L	Panel size: small, medium or large. The panel also scales to fit the plugin window.
?	Opens a pop-up with the design credit, the GFX website address and the address of this manual. Click anywhere to close it.

Parameter list only

INPUT IRON (the input transformer's colour, 30% by default), LIMITER ATTACK and RELEASE (1 ms and 200 ms by default, as on the original), and the GFX output stage: OUTPUT STAGE (CLIP by default, a soft clipper just under 0 dB; LIMIT; OFF), its ceiling, and the house band saturation.

Drift

DRIFT (0 - 100%, 50% by default) is battery sag. The supply voltage wanders slowly and droops under heavy, sustained level, so the preamps' headroom, the limiter thresholds and the transformers' drive all move a little - you hear it most when the unit is pushed. 50% is the standard amount, 100% twice that; 0% is a fresh battery.

Presets

The presets set the four pairs' HPF, TRIM and M/S and the master limiter and iron; faders, pans, mutes and solos are left alone.

Init	Everything clean and flat.
Drum Kit	Gain on each pair, light HPFs on the toms and overheads, more iron and a lower master limit.
Field Rig	Pair 1 as an M/S mic, HPFs for location work.
Band Sub	Gentle HPFs and gain across the pairs.
Dialogue Pair	Two dialogue pairs with HPF at 140 Hz.
Glue Bus	A little gain everywhere, heavy iron and a low master limit.

Tips

- Watch the VU while setting the pair TRIMs, then use the faders to balance.
- For an M/S pair, record mid on the left and side on the right of one stereo item, then send it to a pair with M/S on.

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